

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12414029
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 09, 2025
Inventor(s)	Badic; Biljana et al.

Access load control in peer-to-peer networks

Abstract

Implementations relate to identifying an event disrupting connectivity to a first network; determining, for an apparatus, that the apparatus has a connection to a second network; transmitting a message indicating to one or more neighboring devices that the apparatus has network connectivity; receiving a first relay request from a first device and a second relay request from a second device; forwarding, using the connection to the second network, a message associated with the first relay request; and transmitting, to the second device, a backoff message.

Inventors:	Badic; Biljana (Munich, DE), Qaisrani; Babar (Issaquah, WA)
Applicant:	Apple Inc. (Cupertino, CA)
Family ID:	83400625
Assignee:	Apple Inc. (Cupertino, CA)
Appl. No.:	17/941049
Filed:	September 09, 2022

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20230098700 A1	Mar. 30, 2023

Related U.S. Application Data

continuation parent-doc US 17879023 20220802 PENDING child-doc US 17941049
us-provisional-application US 63249403 20210928

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: H04W40/22 (20090101); H04W72/12 (20230101); H04W4/90 (20180101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **H04W40/22** (20130101); **H04W72/12** (20130101); H04W4/90 (20180201)

Field of Classification Search

CPC: H04W (40/22); H04W (72/12); H04W (4/90); H04W (28/0289); H04W (76/14); H04W (76/50); H04W (88/04); H04W (48/06); H04W (72/566); H04W (74/0875); H04L (67/1074); H04L (67/61); H04L (67/52); H04L (2001/0097)

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
7363382	12/2007	Bakke	709/239	H04L 67/1097
11012874	12/2020	Ananth	N/A	H04B 7/1853
2001/0023455	12/2000	Maeda	N/A	N/A
2005/0147056	12/2004	Chinitz	370/310	H04W 74/0875
2007/0287470	12/2006	Kirke	N/A	N/A
2010/0120392	12/2009	Youn et al.	N/A	N/A
2011/0117907	12/2010	Hooli	455/422.1	H04W 72/02
2015/0172413	12/2014	Yoneda	709/233	H04L 67/63
2018/0124633	12/2017	Hwang et al.	N/A	N/A
2018/0192461	12/2017	Naik et al.	N/A	N/A
2020/0394851	12/2019	Lee et al.	N/A	N/A
2021/0136659	12/2020	Lanev	N/A	H04W 28/02
2021/0266917	12/2020	Damnjanovic	N/A	H04W 72/569
2023/0096571	12/2022	Badic et al.	N/A	N/A

FOREIGN PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Application Date	Country	CPC
104509150	12/2014	CN	N/A
110402599	12/2018	CN	N/A
WO2021239135	12/2020	WO	N/A

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

[No Author Listed] “3rd Generation Partnership Project; Technical Specification Group Core Network and Terminals; Non-Access-Stratum (NAS) protocol for 5G System (5GS); Stage 3; (Release17),” 3GPP TS 24.501 V17.4.1, Sep. 27, 2021, 863 pages. cited by applicant

[No Author Listed] “3rd Generation Partnership Project; Technical Specification Group Core Network and Terminals; Proximity-services (ProSe) in 5G System (5GS) protocol aspects; Stage 3 (Release 17),” 3GPP TS 24.554 V0.4.0, Sep. 10, 2021, 209 pages. cited by applicant

Extended European Search Report in European Appln No. 22193184.3, dated Feb. 23, 2023, 14 pages. cited by applicant

Nokia et al., “Impact of NAS level congestion control for 5G ProSe UE-to-Network Relay,” 3GPP TSG-CT WG1 Meeting #131-e E-meeting, CL-214314, Aug. 19-27, 2021, 10 pages. cited by applicant

Primary Examiner: Srivastava; Vivek

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Fish & Richardson P.C.

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) The present application is a continuation application of and claims priority to U.S. application Ser. No. 17/879,023, filed on Aug. 2, 2022 entitled "Access Load Control in Peer-to-Peer Networks," which claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Application No. 63/249,403, filed on Sep. 28, 2021 entitled "Access Load Control In Peer-To-Peer Networks," which is herein incorporated by reference in its entirety.

BACKGROUND

(1) Direct communication with a network may be unavailable at times and relay communications through another device can be important. However, in high-usage situations, congestion may impact the ability to relay communications.

SUMMARY

(2) In general, some aspects of the subject matter described in this specification can be embodied in methods that include the actions of identifying, by a relay device, a first message received from a first requesting device of a plurality of requesting devices; identifying, by the relay device, a second message received from a second requesting device of the plurality of requesting devices; determining, by the relay device based at least in part on a parameter of the first message, that the first message has a first priority level that satisfies a priority threshold; determining, by the relay device based at least in part on a parameter of the second message, that the second message has a second priority level that does not satisfy the priority threshold; transmitting a relay message to a remote device based at least in part on the first message; and transmitting a backoff message to the second requesting device.

(3) In general, some aspects of the subject matter described in this specification can be embodied in methods that include the actions of generating, based at least in part on a user input, a message related to the electronic device; transmitting the message to a relay device; and identifying, based at least in part on the message, a response message received from the relay device. The response message received from the relay device can be a high priority response message if the relay device determines that the message has a high priority level. The response message received from the relay device can be a backoff message if the relay device determines that the message has a priority level that is different than a high priority level.

(4) In general, some aspects of the subject matter described in this specification can be embodied in methods that include the actions of identifying an event disrupting connectivity to a first network; determining that the apparatus has a connection to a second network; transmitting a message indicating to one or more neighboring devices that the apparatus has network connectivity; receiving a first relay request from a first device and a second relay request from a second device; forwarding, using the connection to the second network, a message associated with the first relay request; and transmitting, to the second device, a backoff message.

(5) In general, some aspects of the subject matter described in this specification can be embodied in methods that include the actions of advertising that the apparatus has network connectivity to at least one destination; receiving two or more request messages, each of the two or more request messages received from a corresponding device of two or more requesting devices that does not

include the at least one destination, where the two or more request messages includes one or more first request messages and one or more second request messages; selecting, from the two or more request messages and using corresponding priorities, the one or more first request messages; forwarding, using the network connectivity and to a corresponding destination from the at least one destination, the one or more first request messages; and transmitting, to each device in a subset of devices from the two or more requesting devices, a backoff message, wherein each second request message from the one or more second request messages was received from a device in the subset of devices.

(6) A system can be configured to perform operations or actions by virtue of having software, firmware, hardware, or a combination thereof installed on the system that in operation causes or cause the system to perform the operations or actions. One or more computer programs can be configured to perform operations or actions by virtue of including instructions that, when executed by data processing apparatus, cause the apparatus to perform the operations or actions. The operations or actions performed either by the system or by the instructions executed by data processing apparatus can include the methods of any one of the described implementations.

(7) The foregoing and other embodiments can each optionally include one or more of the following features, alone or in combination. The first message can be related to a first emergency situation. The second message can be related to a second emergency situation. The first situation and the second situation can be the same situation or different situations. The first message can include a first status message. The second message can include a second status message.

(8) In some implementations, the method can include transmitting, by the relay device based at least in part on the first message or the second message, a request to a remote device. The remote device can include a remote device of an emergency service. The high priority response message can include a request to establish a communication link between the first requesting device and the relay device. The high priority response message can include a request for more information from the first requesting device. The high priority response message or the backoff message can include an indication that the relay device sent a message to a remote system. The backoff message can include an indication of a duration until the second requesting device can transmit another message to the relay device.

(9) In some implementations, the parameter of the first message can be at least one of a message type of the first message, an identity of a user of the first requesting device, a proximity of the first requesting device to the relay device, or a signal quality parameter of the first requesting device. The signal quality parameter can be reference signal received power (RSRP). The first message can be one of a predefined set of messages. The relay device can be a user equipment (UE).

(10) In some implementations, the method can include subdividing, by the relay device, a location, at which the plurality of requesting devices are located, into a plurality of location segments. The first requesting device and the second requesting device can be in a first location segment of the plurality of location segments. The method can include: transmitting, by the relay device based at least in part on a determination that a third message received from a third requesting device in a second location segment of the plurality of location segments has the high priority level, a second high priority response message to the third requesting device; and transmitting, by the relay device based at least in part on the determination that a fourth message received from a fourth requesting device in the second location segment does not have a high priority level, a second backoff message to the fourth requesting device.

(11) In some implementations, generating the message can include identifying, based at least in part on the user input, a preidentified message of a plurality of preidentified messages. The high priority response message can include a request to establish an audio and/or visual communication link between the electronic device and the relay device. The message received from the relay device can be the high priority response message that includes a request for more information from the electronic device. The message received from the relay device can include an indication that the

relay device sent another message to a remote system. The method can include determining whether the message received from the relay device can be a backoff message; and based at least in part on determining that the message received from the relay device can be a backoff message, initiating a timer with a duration that indicates a time for the electronic device to wait before transmitting the message to the relay device again.

(12) The details of one or more implementations of these systems and methods are set forth in the accompanying drawings and the description below. Other features, objects, and advantages of these systems and methods will be apparent from the description and drawings, and from the claims.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 illustrates an example wireless network, in accordance with some implementations.

(2) FIG. 2 depicts an example implementation of a wireless communication system, in accordance with various implementations.

(3) FIG. 3 depicts another example implementation of a communication system that includes requesting devices in relation to a relay device, in accordance with various implementations.

(4) FIG. 4 depicts an example process flow, in accordance with various implementations.

(5) FIG. 5 depicts an example technique to be performed by a relay device, in accordance with various implementations.

(6) FIG. 6 depicts an example technique to be performed by a requesting device, in accordance with various implementations.

(7) FIG. 7 is a flow diagram of an example process for selectively forwarding messages.

(8) FIG. 8 illustrates a user equipment (UE), in accordance with some implementations.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(9) In some situations, a device might not be able to connect, or might have difficulty connecting, with a terrestrial or non-terrestrial network to communicate, e.g., send data. For instance, the device might be in an area with limited or no network coverage. This can occur when the device is located in a sparsely populated area (e.g., wilderness or a large body of water), during an emergency (e.g., when a large number of devices are attempting to use the network), during a disaster (e.g., when some or all network equipment is out of service), and other such situations during which communication demand cannot be satisfied by communication infrastructure for at least a subset of devices.

(10) To enable the device to send a message in such situations, a relay device can provide the device with a network connection. For instance, the relay device can receive a message from the device and forward the message to another device. The other device can include network equipment, e.g., a base station. The other device can include user equipment, e.g., a second user equipment when the relay device is a user equipment. The other device, the relay device, or both, can include a smart device, e.g., a smart camera, a tablet, or a smart watch.

(11) When the situation, or multiple different situations, affect a large number of devices, the relay device might receive too many requests, e.g., from the device and other devices that do not have access, or have limited direct access, to a terrestrial or non-terrestrial network. This can cause the relay device to process requests more slowly than would otherwise occur, particularly when the relay device receives repeat requests from one or more of the devices.

(12) To reduce an amount of network bandwidth used, an amount of computation resources used, or both, the relay device can determine which messages received from the various devices satisfy a priority threshold, e.g., have high or the highest priority. The relay device can process the messages that satisfy the priority threshold (e.g., high priority messages) while transmitting one or more backoff messages to the requesting devices from which the relay device received messages that did

not satisfy the priority threshold (e.g., lower priority messages). The backoff message can cause (or request) a requesting device to wait until a time period expires before sending another message to the relay device. When processing the one or more messages that satisfy the priority threshold (e.g., the highest priority messages), the relay device can create a communication link between the relay device and the corresponding requesting device, forward the high priority message to a remote device, and/or perform another appropriate action. Further, the priority threshold can be adjusted over time, e.g., as the number and/or priority of the received requests changes. In some examples, the priority threshold can be based at least in part on a time when the message was received. In some examples, the priority threshold can be based at least in part on content included in the message.

(13) FIG. 1 illustrates an example wireless network **100**, in accordance with some implementations. The wireless network **100** includes a UE **102** and a base station **104** connected via one or more channels **106A**, **106B** across an air interface **108**. The UE **102** and base station **104** communicate using a system that supports controls for managing the access of the UE **102** to a network via the base station **104**.

(14) For purposes of convenience and without limitation, the wireless network **100** is described in the context of Long Term Evolution (LTE) and Fifth Generation (5G) New Radio (NR) communication standards as defined by the Third Generation Partnership Project (3GPP) technical specifications. More specifically, the wireless network **100** is described in the context of a Non-Standalone (NSA) networks that incorporate both LTE and NR, for example, E-UTRA (Evolved Universal Terrestrial Radio Access)-NR Dual Connectivity (EN-DC) networks, and NE-DC networks. However, the wireless network **100** may also be a Standalone (SA) network that incorporates only NR. Furthermore, other types of communication standards are possible, including future 3GPP systems (e.g., Sixth Generation (6G)) systems, Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE) 802.11 technology (e.g., IEEE 802.11a; IEEE 802.11b; IEEE 802.11g; IEEE 802.11-2007; IEEE 802.11n; IEEE 802.11-2012; IEEE 802.11ac; IEEE 802.11 ax; IEEE 802.11be; and/or other present or future developed IEEE 802.11 technologies), IEEE 802.16 protocols (e.g., WMAN, WiMAX, etc.), 802.15 protocols, or the like. While aspects may be described herein using terminology commonly associated with 5G NR, aspects of the present disclosure can be applied to other systems, such as 3G, 4G, and/or systems subsequent to 5G (e.g., 6G).

(15) In the wireless network **100**, the UE **102** and any other UE in the system may be, for example, any/all of laptop computers, smartphones, tablet computers, machine-type devices such as smart meters or specialized devices for healthcare monitoring, remote security surveillance systems, intelligent transportation systems, or any other wireless devices with or without a user interface. In network **100**, the base station **104** provides the UE **102** network connectivity to a broader network (not shown). This UE **102** connectivity is provided via the air interface **108** in a base station service area provided by the base station **104**. In some implementations, such a broader network may be a wide area network operated by a cellular network provider, or may be the Internet. Each base station service area associated with the base station **104** is supported by antennas integrated with the base station **104**. The service areas are divided into a number of sectors associated with certain antennas. Such sectors may be physically associated with fixed antennas or may be assigned to a physical area with tunable antennas or antenna settings adjustable in a beamforming process used to direct a signal to a particular sector.

(16) The UE **102** includes control circuitry **110** coupled with transmit circuitry **112** and receive circuitry **114**. The transmit circuitry **112** and receive circuitry **114** may each be coupled with one or more antennas. The control circuitry **110** may be adapted to perform operations associated with selection of codecs for communication and to adaption of codecs for wireless communications as part of system congestion control. The control circuitry **110** may include various combinations of application-specific circuitry and baseband circuitry. The transmit circuitry **112** and receive circuitry **114** may be adapted to transmit and receive data, respectively, and may include radio

frequency (RF) circuitry or front-end module (FEM) circuitry, including communications using codecs as described herein.

(17) The control circuitry **110** can perform various operations described in this specification. For instance, the control circuitry **110** can determine a priority of a message, generate a message, initiate a timer, determine whether a timer has expired, and/or a combination of two or more of these.

(18) The transmit circuitry **112** can perform various operations described in this specification. For example, the transmit circuitry **112** can transmit messages to relay devices, transmit priority response messages (e.g., high priority response messages), transmit backoff messages, forward a message to a remote device or system, and/or a combination of two or more of these.

(19) The receive circuitry **114** can perform various operations described in this specification. For instance, the receive circuitry **114** can receive messages from requesting devices, receive priority response messages (e.g., high priority response messages), receive backoff messages, and/or a combination of two or more of these.

(20) In various implementations, aspects of the transmit circuitry **112**, receive circuitry **114**, and control circuitry **110** may be integrated in various ways to implement the circuitry described herein. The control circuitry **110** may be adapted or configured to perform various operations, such as those described elsewhere in this disclosure related to a UE. The transmit circuitry **112** may transmit a plurality of multiplexed uplink physical channels. The plurality of uplink physical channels may be multiplexed according to time division multiplexing (TDM) and/or frequency division multiplexing (FDM), along with carrier aggregation. The transmit circuitry **112** may be configured to receive block data from the control circuitry **110** for transmission across the air interface **108**. Similarly, the receive circuitry **114** may receive a plurality of multiplexed downlink physical channels from the air interface **108** and relay the physical channels to the control circuitry **110**. The plurality of downlink physical channels may be multiplexed according to TDM and/or FDM, along with carrier aggregation. The transmit circuitry **112** and the receive circuitry **114** may transmit and receive, respectively, both control data and content data (e.g., messages, images, video, etc.), e.g., structured within data blocks that are carried by the physical channels.

(21) FIG. 1 also illustrates the base station **104**, e.g., one implementation of a remote device. In some implementations, the base station **104** may be an NG radio access network (RAN) or a 5G RAN, an E-UTRAN, a non-terrestrial cell, or a legacy RAN, such as a UTRAN or GERAN. As used herein, the term “NG RAN” or the like may refer to the base station **104** that operates in an NR or 5G wireless network **100**, and the term “E-UTRAN” or the like may refer to a base station **104** that operates in an LTE or 4G wireless network **100**. The UE **102** utilizes connections (or channels) **106A**, **106B**, each of which includes a physical communications interface or layer.

(22) The base station **104** circuitry may include control circuitry **116** coupled with transmit circuitry **118** and receive circuitry **120**. The transmit circuitry **118** and receive circuitry **120** may each be coupled with one or more antennas (shared or dedicated) that may be used to enable communications via the air interface **108**.

(23) The control circuitry **116** may be adapted to perform operations for analyzing and selecting codecs, managing congestion control and bandwidth limitation communications from a base station, determining whether a base station is codec aware, and communicating with a codec-aware base station to manage codec selection for various communication operations described herein. The transmit circuitry **118** and receive circuitry **120** may be adapted to transmit and receive data, respectively, to/from a UE connected to the base station **104** using data generated with various codecs described herein.

(24) In such implementations, the one or more channels **106A**, **106B** are illustrated as an air interface to enable communicative coupling, and can be consistent with cellular communications protocols, such as a GSM protocol, a CDMA network protocol, a PTT protocol, a POC protocol, a UMTS protocol, a 3GPP LTE protocol, an Advanced long term evolution (LTE-A) protocol, an

LTE-based access to unlicensed spectrum (LTE-U), a 5G protocol, a NR protocol, an NR-based access to unlicensed spectrum (NR-U) protocol, and/or any of the other communications protocols discussed herein. In some implementations, the UE **102** may directly exchange communication data via a ProSe interface. The ProSe interface may alternatively be referred to as a side link (SL) interface and may include one or more logical channels, including but not limited to a PSCCH, a PSSCH, a PSDCH, and a PSBCH.

(25) FIG. 2 depicts an example implementation of a wireless communication system **200**, in accordance with various implementations. The communication system **200** may include a relay device **205**. The relay device may be, for example, a UE that is, includes, is included in, or is otherwise related to an electronic device such as electronic devices **200** or **300**.

(26) The relay device **205** may be communicatively coupled with one or more communication systems that are configured to allow the relay device **205** to send or receive messages, data, or information to another device or system that is remote from the relay device **205**. Such communication systems may be or include a terrestrial system, e.g., a cellular system **210** or a WiFi system **220**, a non-terrestrial system, e.g., a satellite system **215** or a high-altitude platform (HAP) system, or any combination of these. The cellular system **210** may be or include a 4G network, a 5G network, or some other network, e.g., as described above. Similarly, the WiFi system **220** may be similar to a WiFi system described above. It will be understood that these systems are non-exclusive, and may overlap (e.g., the relay device **205** may be communicatively coupled with the cellular system **210** through a WiFi system **220** and/or a satellite system **215**).

(27) The relay device **205** is further communicatively coupled with one or more requesting devices, such as requesting device(s) **225**. Specifically, the relay device **205** and the requesting device(s) **225** may be communicatively coupled by a peer-to-peer communication protocol. The peer-to-peer communication protocol may include various channels, such as a synchronization channel, a control channel, a shared data channel, another appropriate type of channel, or a combination of two or more of these. Alternatively, a single channel can be used for multiple, or all, communications.

(28) After synchronization between two or more devices is established, the devices can perform an authentication process via the control channel, and then the devices can exchange communication messages via the data channel.

(29) In some implementations, a dedicated slot for message exchange, e.g., an emergency slot, may be added into an existing communication protocol and used for the communication described in this specification. In some implementations, the communication protocol may allow for connection of devices at distances up to 2 kilometers (km), while in other implementations the communication protocol may have greater or lesser distance capabilities (e.g., 1 km, 2.5 km, etc.).

(30) Similarly to the relay device **205**, the requesting device(s) **225** may each be, for example, a UE that is, includes, is included in, or is otherwise related to an electronic device such as electronic devices **200** or **300**. In some implementations, there may be one or more intermediary devices (e.g., a router, a relay, or some other device) that is communicatively coupled between the relay device **205** and one or more of the one or more requesting devices **225**. In some implementations, the requesting device(s) **225** may be of a same form factor as the relay device **205** (e.g., they may both be a cellular telephone), while in other implementations at least one of the requesting device(s) **225** may have a different form factor than the relay device **205** (e.g., the relay device **205** may be a cellular telephone while a requesting device **225** is a tablet). It will also be noted that although only three requesting devices **225** are depicted in FIG. 2, in other implementations the communication system **200** may include more or fewer requesting devices **225** that are communicatively coupled to the relay device **205**.

(31) FIG. 3 depicts another example implementation of a communication system **300** that includes requesting devices **325** in relation to a relay device **305**, in accordance with various implementations. The relay device **305** and requesting devices **325** may be similar to, and share one

or more characteristics with, relay device **205** and requesting device(s) **225**, respectively, of FIG. 2. (32) When an event arises, such as a disaster, individuals such as the users of the requesting device(s) **325** may seek to communicate. Accordingly, the requesting device(s) **325** may transmit a number of status messages, e.g., one or more status messages. Such status messages are generalized herein to two different types of status messages. The first type of status message is a SoS or “emergency” type message that includes a request for help or other assistance. The second type of status message is referred an “update” type message that is intended to indicate an update in status or another type of status message, but is not a request for help. Such messages may be, for example, when a user wishes to inform another person about their current location, that the user is safe or unharmed, or a combination of both.

(33) As previously noted, in a disaster scenario, several requesting devices **325** (e.g., on the order of hundreds or thousands of devices) may be transmitting messages or other data generally concurrently, which may overload a conventional communication network (especially if such a network is damaged or otherwise affected by the disaster scenario) or a conventional communication network may not be available, at least for some requesting devices **325**. In some implementations, the use of the relay device **305** as a central point of contact for the requesting device(s) **325** may be desirable, however such a situation may result in a significant delay to establish connection with the relay device **305** by a requesting device **325** due to congestion. Additionally, attempting to connect the relay device **305** to each requesting device **325** may quickly reduce the battery level of a relay device **305**. Therefore, implementations herein relate to techniques to prioritize communications in a relay scenario, e.g., a disaster, such that the devices of the communication system **300** are served in a timely manner by the relay device **305**.

(34) Generally, implementations herein may include techniques to control congestion or overload at the relay device **305**, reduce delay in the affected area, or both. At a high level, in some implementations, a requesting device **325** may transmit a status message as described above. The status message may include one or more data fields, such as content of the status message, an indication of a type of the status message (e.g., whether the message is an emergency type message or an update type message), an identifier for the requesting device, and data related to a location of the requesting device. The identifier may be, for example, a telephone number of the requesting device, an email address, a network identifier, a physical identifier of the requesting device **325**, or some other type of identifier.

(35) In some implementations, the status message may be one of a pre-defined set of status messages, and the content of the status message may include an indication of pre-defined content. In this case, the relay device **305** may compare the indication of the pre-defined content against a data structure, such as a look-up table, to identify the content of the status message. The use of a pre-defined set of status messages may be desirable to, for example, reduce the size or required bandwidth of the status message. In some implementations, the content of the status message may be based on user-entered content (e.g., a user-entered alphanumeric message or some other type of content).

(36) The relay device **305** may then subdivide the affected area into two or more different segments, such as location segments. For example, FIG. 3 shows four different location segments that generally represent quadrants in accordance with the four cardinal directions of North, South, East, and West. These quadrants can include a northwest quadrant, a northeast quadrant, a southeast quadrant, and a southwest quadrant.

(37) Additionally, in some implementations the area can be further subdivided, as shown by the concentric circles, e.g., based on range. In such implementations, the area may include requesting device(s) **325** that are within a first range of the relay device **305** (e.g., requesting devices **325** within the circle having a range **R1**) in a first set and include others of the requesting device(s) **325**. (e.g., requesting devices **325** that are with the circle with the range **R2**, but outside of the circle with the range **R1**) in a second set. In some implementations, **R1** may be on the order of one

kilometer (km) and R2 is on the order of two km. Alternatively, or additionally, requesting devices 325 that are beyond a given range may be excluded.

(38) However, it will be understood that the number of subdivisions, the number of ranges, the values for such ranges, how the subdivisions are oriented, or a combination of these, may be different in different implementations. For instance, the area can be subdivided based at least in part on factors such as the location of the relay device 305, the location(s) of the requesting device(s) 325, factors that are pre-defined or pre-stored on the relay device 305, some other factor or criteria, or a combination of two or more of these.

(39) In some implementations, the relay device 305 may prioritize communication from one or more of the requesting devices 325 based on one or more criteria. One such criteria may be the message type. For example, emergency type messages may be given a higher priority than update type messages.

(40) Another criteria may be location. For example, requesting devices 325 within range R1 may be given a higher priority than requesting devices 325 beyond range R1, e.g., because the signal strength (and thus efficiency of communication) between the relay device 305 and the requesting device 325 within range R1 may be greater than the signal strength between the relay device 305 and requesting devices outside of range R1.

(41) In some implementations, the relay device 305 can prioritize at least some of the requesting devices 325 using signal strength and/or physical position of the requesting device 325, e.g., with respect to the relay device 305. In some implementations, the relay device 305 can prioritize the requesting devices 325 using whichever parameter is available first, such as the signal strength or the physical position. Further, the relay device 305 can modify the prioritization as other parameters for a requesting device 325, or other requesting devices 325, become available.

(42) In some situations, e.g., when a very large number of devices are within the area of the communication system 300, it may be desirable to have a pre-prioritized list of devices, user identifiers, and/or accounts that correspond to the requesting devices, to assist with quickly and efficiently prioritizing the various status messages. One such list may include criteria such as a relationship of the requesting device 325, or the corresponding user to the relay device 305, or the corresponding user.

(43) For example, one such efficient prioritization may include a recognition that a user's family group may be smaller than a user's friend group (e.g., a user's contact list), which may in turn be smaller than the group of all devices in the area of the communication system 300. Therefore, for the sake of efficient prioritization of status messages, the relay device 305 may prioritize status messages that include an identifier, such as one or more of the identifiers above, that is used to identify the relationship of the user of the requesting device 325 to the user of the relay device 305. However, it will be noted that, in some implementations, different relationships may be used to efficiently prioritize messages by the relay device 305. Some examples of different relationships can include those based on work events, those based on living situation (e.g., individuals in the same block, neighborhood, dormitory, apartment building, etc.), those based on extracurricular activities, those based on pre-sorted emergency-related lists, such as those that may be operated by cities or states, etc.

(44) In some implementations, a signal quality factor, such as reference signal received power (RSRP), reference signal received quality (RSRQ), or a combination of both, or some other signal quality factor that provides an indication of a quality of a signal between the relay device 305 and one or more of the requesting devices 325 may be used as a prioritization criteria. In some implementations, this factor may be used for all prioritization decisions by the relay device 305. In some implementations, the signal quality factor may be used as a "tie-breaker" or deciding factor, e.g., in the event that the one or more other factors in use do not sufficiently narrow the list of requesting devices 325 that are attempting to communicate with the relay device 305.

(45) Based on the different prioritization criteria, the relay device 305 can identify messages

received from various ones of the requesting devices 325 as having a higher priority than others of the messages. In some implementations, the relay device 305 can determine that the messages that have a higher priority satisfy a priority threshold. The priority threshold can indicate that a predetermined number of highest priority messages should be selected. In some implementations, the priority threshold can be a predetermined value, e.g., a numeric value. In these implementations, the relay device 305 can determine that the higher priority messages satisfy the priority threshold when the higher priority messages have corresponding priorities that are greater than, equal to, or greater than or equal to the predetermined priority threshold.

(46) The relay device 305 can determine such a prioritization may be, at least in part, assigning different weights to different ones of the criteria. As a simplified example, using only the message type and the location parameters, the message type may have weights as shown in Table 1.

(47) TABLE-US-00001 TABLE 1 Message Type Prioritization Weights
Emergency type = P1
Update type = P2
Other type = P3

(48) The location type may have weights as shown in Table 2.

(49) TABLE-US-00002 TABLE 2 Location Type Prioritization Weights
 $\text{Location} \leq R1 = W1$
 $R1 < \text{Location} \leq R2 = W2$
 $R2 < \text{Location} = W3$

(50) In this implementation, the prioritization calculation may be as follows, from highest priority to lowest priority: P1W1 (highest priority), P1W2, P2W1, P2W2, P1W3, . . . P3W3 (lowest priority).

(51) It will be understood, however, that the above example is intended as one example of prioritization, and other implementations may be different. For example, in the above-shown example, message type is given greater consideration than location, which is why P1W2 is shown as having a higher priority than P2W1. However, in other implementations location may be given greater consideration. In some implementations, different ones of the weights may have a similar consideration (e.g., P1W2 may be given the same priority as P2W1), or one or more additional/alternative factors may be used, such as the signal quality factor described above.

(52) In some implementations, instead of or in addition to prioritizing messages, the relay device 305 can prioritize requesting devices 325. For example, the relay device 305 can determine a priority for a particular requesting device 325 based at least in part on the messages the relay device 305 received from the particular requesting device 325. This can occur when the relay device 305 waits to prioritize messages until a period of time has passed, e.g., when the priority threshold indicates the predetermined number of highest priority messages that should be selected. In these examples, the relay device 305 can receive multiple messages from the particular requesting device 325 and determine a priority for the particular requesting device 325 based at least in part on the multiple messages. For instance, the relay device 305 can determine a priority for each of the multiple messages and then determine a priority for the particular requesting device 325 based at least in part on the priorities for the multiple messages.

(53) In some implementations, the relay device 305 may serve those requesting devices 325 with messages that have higher priorities before serving others of the requesting devices 325 with messages that have lower priorities. For example, the relay device 305 may transmit a high priority emergency response message to the requesting device(s) 325 with the highest priority, while sending a “backoff message” to requesting device(s) 325 with a lower priority.

(54) The high priority emergency response message may include a request for two-way communication, a request for establishment of an audio channel, a request for establishment of a video channel, a request for more information, an indication that an emergency service (e.g., police, search and rescue, fire department, medical services, etc.) has been contacted, some other message, or a combination of two or more of these. In response to sending a request for more information, the relay device 305 can receive additional information from a corresponding requesting device 325. The relay device 305 can use the additional information to determine a priority for a device, a priority for a request message, or both. In addition to sending the higher priority emergency

response message, the relay device **305** may contact one or more of the above-listed emergency services on behalf of the higher-priority requesting device **325** prior to establishment of the two-way communication.

(55) The backoff message may include, for example, an indication of a backoff timer, which is to be used by the requesting device **325** prior to re-attempting communication with the relay device **305**. When the lower priority requesting device **325** receives the backoff timer, e.g., a message that indicates a duration for the backoff timer, the lower priority requesting device **325** can initiate a timer indicated by the duration. When the lower priority requesting device **325** determines that the timer has expired, the lower priority requesting device **325** can re-attempt communication with the relay device **305**, e.g., can send another message to the relay device **305**. The other message can be the same message the lower priority requesting device **325** previously sent to the relay device **305** or a different message. In some implementations, the lower priority requesting device **325** can re-attempt communication with a different relay device, e.g., when the lower priority requesting device **325** determines that the other relay device has a better connection with the lower priority requesting device **325** than the relay device **305**. In some implementations, the backoff message may further include an indication, e.g., that the relay device **305** has contacted an emergency service, as described above.

(56) The relay device **305** can identify any appropriate number of requesting devices **325** as having a higher priority. In some implementations, the relay device **305** may identify only a single requesting device **325** as having a higher priority. In some implementations, the relay device **305** may identify a single requesting device **325** per subdivision (e.g., per quadrant) or multiple requesting devices **325** per subdivision as having a higher priority. In such implementations, the relay device **305** may establish a higher-priority communication with multiple ones of the requesting devices **325** (e.g., one requesting device **325** per subdivision). The number of requesting devices **325** identified as having a higher priority may be based on a criteria, such as bandwidth of the relay device **305**, the number of subdivisions, the number of requesting devices, a predetermined quantity, a combination of two or more of these factors, or one or more other factors.

(57) In some implementations, for example where a single requesting device **325** per subdivision is identified as having a higher priority, that requesting device **325** may take on one or more of the functions of a relay device, such as relay device **305**, for one or more other requesting devices **325** in that subdivision. In this way, network load may be shared between different ones of the devices, and overall network traffic may be significantly reduced.

(58) FIG. 4 depicts an example process flow **400**, in accordance with various implementations. As shown in FIG. 4, the process flow **400** may include communication between a relay device **405**, a requesting device **425A**, and a requesting device **425B**. In some implementations, the relay device **405** may be similar to relay device **205** and/or relay device **305**, and the requesting devices **425A/425B** may be similar to requesting devices **225** and/or requesting devices **325**. It will be understood that this example is intended as a highly simplified example showing communication between two requesting devices and a relay device. In other implementations, there may be more requesting devices, e.g., on the order of tens, hundreds, or thousands of requesting devices. Therefore, this process may be scaled appropriately, such that it is repeated for requesting devices in different subdivisions of the area as described above.

(59) As shown in FIG. 4, requesting device **425A** may transmit a status message to the relay device **405** at **410**. Similarly, the requesting device **425B** may transmit a status message to the relay device **405** at **415**. In some implementations, the status messages at **410** and **415** may be similar to the status messages described above. Although the examples described here refer to status messages, other appropriate types of messages can be used in similar processes, by the relay device **405** and the requesting devices **425A-B**. For instance, the requesting device **425A** can transmit a request message to the relay device **405** at **410** and the requesting device **425B** can transmit a text message,

e.g., a status message or another appropriate type of message, to the relay device **405** at **415**.

(60) The relay device **405** may process the status messages at **420**. In some implementations, processing the status messages may include identifying the priorities of the different status messages as described above. Processing the status messages may additionally or alternatively include performing one or more other actions based on the status message(s), such as contacting an emergency service, establishing subdivisions, etc. as described above.

(61) Based at least in part on the processing of the status messages at **420**, the relay device **405** may transmit a high priority emergency response message and/or a backoff message to one or more of the requesting devices, as described above. For example, in the implementation depicted in FIG. 4, the status message received from a first requesting device **425A** at **410** is identified as a higher priority status message than the status message received from a second requesting device **425B**. As a result, the relay device **405** may transmit a higher priority emergency response message at **430** to the first requesting device **425A** as shown. The status message received from the second requesting device **425B** at **415** may be identified as being of a lower priority, and the relay device **405** may transmit a backoff message at **435** to the second requesting device **425B**.

(62) It will be understood that the implementations described above and herein are intended as example implementations, and other implementations may vary. For example, there may additional priority levels than the “higher” and “lower” levels described herein. Additionally, the terms “higher” and “lower” are intended to describe priority levels that are relative to one another for the sake of discussion herein. Additionally, although the transmission of certain messages such as those at **410/415** and **430/435** are depicted as being sequential, in other implementations one or more of the messages may be transmitted in a different order than shown, concurrently, or at least partially overlapping in time with one another.

(63) In some implementations, the relay device **405** can determine that two or more messages have the same priority, and that priority is the highest priority at least presently being processed. In these implementations, the relay device **405** can determine to send an emergency response message (or other affirmative response message) to each of the two or more requesting devices **425** associated with the two or more messages that have the same priority. Further, the relay device **405** can send the response message to the two or more requesting devices **425** substantially concurrently (e.g., as a broadcast), serially (e.g., as unicast), or using any other available transmission scheme.

(64) In some implementations, the relay device **405** can identify as higher priority messages two or more messages that have different priorities. For instance, when the relay device **405** has a parameter that indicates a predetermined quantity of requesting devices for which the corresponding message should be processed, e.g., to which response messages should be sent or for which the corresponding message should be forwarded or both, the relay device **405** can select the predetermined quantity of requesting devices that have the highest priority messages compared to other messages received. The relay device **405** can then process the predetermined quantity of highest priority messages. In other implementations, other prioritization schemes can be used. For instance, the relay device can identify as higher priority all received messages that exceed one or more thresholds. The thresholds can be any appropriate threshold, such as a time threshold, a ranking threshold, etc. Further, the relay device **405** can further differentiate messages within a prioritization class, such as by acting on one or more higher priority messages while sending a shorter back-off (or other delay) message to one or more devices associated with other higher priority messages.

(65) In some implementations, the relay device **405** can forward messages using a time at which the messages were received. For instance, the relay device **405** can forward one or more first messages received within a first time period while responding with backoff messages for one or more second messages received within a second time period. In some examples, the relay device can perform this operation using one or more additional thresholds.

(66) FIG. 5 depicts an example technique **500** to be performed by a relay device. The relay device

can be a device such as relay device **205** or can be some other relay device, in accordance with various implementations.

(67) The technique **500** may include identifying, at **505**, a first message received from a first requesting device of a plurality of requesting devices at a location. In some implementations, the first message can be related to an emergency situation or other event at the location. In some implementations, the location can be a geographic area, such as a park, a campus, a city, a town, or another appropriate location. In some other implementations, the location can be associated with a communication range, such as an effective range over which device-to-device or peer-to-peer communications (or other such mesh communications) can be conveyed.

(68) The technique **500** may further include identifying, at **510**, a second message from a second requesting device of the plurality of requesting devices at the location. In some examples, the second message also can be related to an emergency situation, e.g., at a second location when it is the same emergency situation or at the location. In some other examples, the first message and the second message can be related to different situations or events.

(69) The requesting devices may be similar to, for example, requesting devices **425A/425B**, or can be any other device(s) suitable for requesting relay communications as described herein. The message(s) may be similar to, for example, the status messages described above with respect to elements **410** or **415**, or the status message(s) can be implemented using any other message format appropriate for relay communications.

(70) The technique **500** may further include determining, at **515**, based at least in part on a parameter of the first message, that the first message has a first high priority level that satisfies a priority threshold. The first priority level can be a high priority level.

(71) The technique **500** may further include determining, at **520**, based at least on a parameter of the second message, that the second message has a second priority level that does not satisfy the priority threshold. The second priority level is different from the first priority level. The second priority level can be a low priority level, a medium priority level, etc. that is lower than the first, higher priority level. The parameter may be or include, for example, any/all of a location of the requesting device, a device identifier, an identity of the user of the requesting device, a signal quality parameter, a type of the message, or some other parameter as described above.

(72) The technique **500** may further include transmitting, at **525** based at least on the first message, a high priority emergency response message to the first requesting device. The transmission can be based at least in part on the determination that the first priority level satisfies the priority threshold.

(73) In some implementations, the technique **500** can include transmitting the high priority emergency response message to the first requesting device based on a determination that the first message has the highest priority level. The high priority emergency response message may be similar to, for example, the high priority emergency response message described above with respect to element **430**.

(74) The technique **500** may further include transmitting, at **530** based at least on the second message, a backoff message to the second requesting device. The transmission can be based at least in part on the determination that the second priority level does not satisfy the priority threshold.

(75) In some implementations, the technique **500** can include transmitting the backoff message to the second requesting device based at least on a determination that the second message has a lower priority level than the highest priority level. Such a backoff message may be similar to, for example, the backoff message described above with respect to element **435**. In some implementations, the high priority level can be determined relative to the messages received over a given period. For example, in the absence of a higher priority level message being received during a window of time, a message with an intermediate priority can be deemed a high priority (or highest priority) message.

(76) FIG. **6** depicts an example technique **600** to be performed by a requesting device, such as one of requesting devices **425A**, **425B**, or some other requesting device discussed herein, in accordance

with various implementations.

(77) The technique **600** may include generating, at **605**, based on a user input, a message related to an event, e.g., an emergency situation, at a location of the requesting device. In some implementations, the message may be similar to those discussed above, e.g., with respect to elements **410** or **415**. In other implementations the message may have any other suitable format. As discussed above, the message may be generated based on selection of a pre-defined message, through custom input (e.g., text, image, voice, etc.), through a combination thereof, or through some other input.

(78) The technique **600** may further include transmitting, at **610**, the message to a relay device, such as relay device **405**. Such a transmission may occur by way of any wireless communication technique, including cellular (e.g., 3GPP), WiFi (e.g., 802.11), Bluetooth, UWB, or other such communication technique/protocol, or through a combination of two or more of these.

(79) The technique **600** may further include identifying, at **615**, a message received from the relay device, e.g., in response to the message transmitted at **610**. The received message may be a high priority emergency response message, a backoff message, an acknowledgement (ACK) message, or any other such message.

(80) It will be understood that the techniques **500** and **600** described above, and other techniques or processes discussed or described herein, are intended as example techniques and may vary in other implementations. For example, other techniques may have more or fewer elements than are depicted herein, elements that occur in a different order than depicted (e.g. the sequence of occurrence may be different, or elements may occur at least partially concurrently with one another), etc. Other variations may be present.

(81) FIG. 7 is a flow diagram of an example process **700** for selectively forwarding messages. For example, the process **700** can be used by the relay device **205**, the relay device **305**, or the relay device **405**. In some examples, the process **700** can be used by a processor, e.g., a baseband processor.

(82) A relay device determines, based at least in part on a first network status and a second network status, to advertise that the apparatus current has network connectivity (**705**). The first network status can be of the relay device. The second network status can be of the relay device or another device, e.g., a requesting device. The relay device can determine the status of another device by receiving a message from the other device or inferring, e.g., using data received from a third party system, a network connectivity status of the other device based at least in part on data the relay device receives. The data the relay device receives can include an alert, an advertisement, a status indicator, news data, etc., that indicates that one or more devices, e.g., in an area within a threshold distance from the relay device, do not have network connectivity.

(83) The relay device advertises that the apparatus currently has network connectivity to at least one destination (**710**). For instance, the relay device can transmit, e.g., broadcast, a message that indicates that the relay device has network connectivity. The connectivity confirmation can be sent in response to any appropriate trigger, such as determining that one or more neighboring devices do not have network connectivity. Separately or in conjunction with the connectivity notification, the relay device can notify any/all of the compatible devices within a range, e.g., an effective communication range, a threshold range, a predetermine range, etc., that it can act as a relay device. In some instances, the relay device can communicate with neighboring devices using an interface other than the interface associated with the network type for which other devices do not have network connectivity. For instance, if the relay device determines that another device likely does not have terrestrial network connectivity, while the relay device has non-terrestrial network connectivity, the relay device can transmit the advertisement using a short range communication protocol, e.g., Bluetooth or WiFi. Alternatively, the relay device can communicate with neighboring devices using the same interface. For example, the relay device can use cellular device-to-device (D2D) communication when neighboring devices do not, or likely do not, have cellular network

connectivity.

(84) The relay device can receive two or more request messages, with each of the two or more request messages being received from a respective device of two or more requesting devices (**715**). In some examples, the relay device can receive a first relay request from a first device and a second relay request from a second device. For example, following an advertisement or other notification sent by the relay device, the relay device can receive two or more request messages, e.g., requesting communication relay. In some instances, the relay device can receive multiple messages at substantially the same time or within the same time window. In other instances, the relay device can receive messages at different times. In some instances, the two or more requesting devices might not include the at least one destination with which the apparatus currently has network connectivity.

(85) The relay device selects, from the two or more request messages and using corresponding priorities, one or more first request messages (**720**). The relay device can determine respective priority levels for the two or more request messages, and/or for corresponding devices from which the relay device received the two or more request messages. The relay device can use the respective priority levels, at least in part, to select the one or more first request messages.

(86) The relay device can select the first request messages at any appropriate time. In some implementations, the relay device selects the first request messages as the first request messages are received from corresponding requesting devices. In some implementations, the relay device can select the first request messages after expiration of a time period. In some instances, the time period can begin upon the earliest receipt of the two or more request messages.

(87) The relay device forwards, using the network to which it has connectivity and to a corresponding destination from the at least one destination, the one or more first request messages (**725**). For instance, the relay device may forward, using the connection to the second network, a message associated with the first relay request.

(88) The relay device may have a connection to a non-terrestrial network, and the relay device can use that non-terrestrial network to forward the one or more first request messages, e.g., to another communication network, the Internet, etc. The relay device can determine an intended destination for a request message based at least in part on data associated with the request message, e.g., such as included in a field of the request message header or payload.

(89) The relay device transmits, to one or more devices of the two or more requesting devices, a backoff message (**730**). For instance, the relay device may transmit, to the second device, a backoff message. A second request message of the one or more second request messages can be received from a device in the one or more devices of the two or more requesting devices. For example, in some implementations, the relay device can broadcast the backoff message addressed to devices in the one or more devices.

(90) In some examples, after forwarding the one or more first messages, the relay device can transmit a second backoff message to the devices from which the relay device received the one or more first request messages. In some implementations, the second backoff message can include an instruction for the recipient device to back off, e.g., for a time period or until the relay device sends another message allowing for subsequent communications. The time period can be the same as, or have a different length than, a second time period in the backoff message sent to the subset of devices. The first time period in a backoff message sent to the devices from which the first request messages were received can have a longer time, a shorter time period, or the same time period as the period indicated as the second time period.

(91) The order of operations in the process **700** described above is illustrative only, and selectively forwarding messages can be performed in different orders. For example, the relay device can perform operation **720**, at least in part, before performing one or both of operations **705** and **710**. This can occur when the relay device receives a first request message and uses, at least in part, data from the first request message to determine the second network status of a device from which the

first request message was received. In some implementations, the relay device can perform operations **725** and **730** substantially concurrently or such that they at least partially overlap in time. In some implementations, the relay device can perform operation **730** and then operation **725**. (92) In some implementations, the process **700** can include additional operations, fewer operations, or some of the operations can be divided into multiple operations. For example, the relay device can perform operations **710** through **725**; operations **710** through **720** and operation **730**; without performing the other operations in the process **700**. In some examples, the process **700** can include identifying an event disrupting connectivity to a first network. The process **700** can include determining that the apparatus has a connection to a second network. The process **700** can include transmitting a message indicating to one or more neighboring devices that the apparatus has network connectivity, e.g., instead of advertising the message.

(93) The examples described in this specification can relate to other types of situations, messages, or both. For instance, although some examples are described with respect to a relay device receiving, or a requesting device sending, a status message, other implementations can use other types of messages. For example, in some implementations, the message can be a non-status message, such as a non-status text message or email.

(94) Although some examples are described with reference to emergency situations, the devices described in this specification and use the described operations in other types of situations. For instance, a device can send a message when the device has limited or no connectivity with a wireless network but is able to transmit data to another device, e.g., another UE.

(95) FIG. **8** illustrates a UE **800**, in accordance with some implementations. The UE **800** may be similar to and substantially interchangeable with UE **102** of FIG. **1**.

(96) The UE **800** may be any mobile or non-mobile computing device, such as, for example, mobile phones, computers, tablets, industrial wireless sensors (for example, microphones, carbon dioxide sensors, pressure sensors, humidity sensors, thermometers, motion sensors, accelerometers, laser scanners, fluid level sensors, inventory sensors, electric voltage/current meters, actuators, etc.), video surveillance/monitoring devices (for example, cameras, video cameras, etc.), wearable devices (for example, a smart watch), relaxed-IoT devices.

(97) The UE **800** may include processors **802**, RF interface circuitry **804**, memory/storage **806**, user interface **808**, sensors **810**, driver circuitry **812**, power management integrated circuit (PMIC) **814**, antenna structure **816**, and battery **818**. The components of the UE **800** may be implemented as integrated circuits (ICs), portions thereof, discrete electronic devices, or other modules, logic, hardware, software, firmware, or a combination thereof. The block diagram of FIG. **7** is intended to show a high-level view of some of the components of the UE **800**. However, some of the components shown may be omitted, additional components may be present, and different arrangement of the components shown may occur in other implementations.

(98) The components of the UE **800** may be coupled with various other components over one or more interconnects **820**, which may represent any type of interface, input/output, bus (local, system, or expansion), transmission line, trace, optical connection, etc. that allows various circuit components (on common or different chips or chipsets) to interact with one another.

(99) The processors **802** may include processor circuitry such as, for example, baseband processor circuitry (BB) **822A**, central processor unit circuitry (CPU) **822B**, and graphics processor unit circuitry (GPU) **822C**. The processors **802** may include any type of circuitry or processor circuitry that executes or otherwise operates computer-executable instructions, such as program code, software modules, or functional processes from memory/storage **806** to cause the UE **800** to perform operations as described herein.

(100) In some implementations, the baseband processor circuitry **822A** may access a communication protocol stack **824** in the memory/storage **806** to communicate over a 3GPP compatible network. In general, the baseband processor circuitry **822A** may access the communication protocol stack to: perform user plane functions at a PHY layer, MAC layer, RLC

layer, PDCP layer, SDAP layer, and PDU layer; and perform control plane functions at a PHY layer, MAC layer, RLC layer, PDCP layer, RRC layer, and a non-access stratum layer. In some implementations, the PHY layer operations may additionally/alternatively be performed by the components of the RF interface circuitry **804**. The baseband processor circuitry **822A** may generate or process baseband signals or waveforms that carry information in 3GPP-compatible networks. In some implementations, the waveforms for NR may be based cyclic prefix OFDM “CP-OFDM” in the uplink or downlink, and discrete Fourier transform spread OFDM “DFT-S-OFDM” in the uplink.

(101) The memory/storage **806** may include one or more non-transitory, computer-readable media that includes instructions (for example, communication protocol stack **824**) that may be executed by one or more of the processors **802** to cause the UE **800** to perform various operations described herein. The memory/storage **806** include any type of volatile or non-volatile memory that may be distributed throughout the UE **800**. In some implementations, some of the memory/storage **806** may be located on the processors **802** themselves (for example, L1 and L2 cache), while other memory/storage **806** is external to the processors **802** but accessible thereto via a memory interface. The memory/storage **806** may include any suitable volatile or non-volatile memory such as, but not limited to, dynamic random access memory (DRAM), static random access memory (SRAM), erasable programmable read only memory (EPROM), electrically erasable programmable read only memory (EEPROM), Flash memory, solid-state memory, or any other type of memory device technology.

(102) The RF interface circuitry **804** may include transceiver circuitry and radio frequency front module (RFEM) that allows the UE **800** to communicate with other devices over a radio access network. The RF interface circuitry **804** may include various elements arranged in transmit or receive paths. These elements may include, for example, switches, mixers, amplifiers, filters, synthesizer circuitry, control circuitry, etc.

(103) In the receive path, the RFEM may receive a radiated signal from an air interface via antenna structure **816** and proceed to filter and amplify (with a low-noise amplifier) the signal. The signal may be provided to a receiver of the transceiver that downconverts the RF signal into a baseband signal that is provided to the baseband processor of the processors **802**.

(104) In the transmit path, the transmitter of the transceiver up-converts the baseband signal received from the baseband processor and provides the RF signal to the RFEM. The RFEM may amplify the RF signal through a power amplifier prior to the signal being radiated across the air interface via the antenna **816**.

(105) In various implementations, the RF interface circuitry **804** may be configured to transmit/receive signals in a manner compatible with NR access technologies.

(106) The antenna **816** may include antenna elements to convert electrical signals into radio waves to travel through the air and to convert received radio waves into electrical signals. The antenna elements may be arranged into one or more antenna panels. The antenna **816** may have antenna panels that are omnidirectional, directional, or a combination thereof to enable beamforming and multiple input, multiple output communications. The antenna **816** may include microstrip antennas, printed antennas fabricated on the surface of one or more printed circuit boards, patch antennas, phased array antennas, etc. The antenna **816** may have one or more panels designed for specific frequency bands including bands in FR1 or FR2.

(107) The user interface **808** includes various input/output (I/O) devices designed to enable user interaction with the UE **800**. The user interface **808** includes input device circuitry and output device circuitry. Input device circuitry includes any physical or virtual means for accepting an input including, inter alia, one or more physical or virtual buttons (for example, a reset button), a physical keyboard, keypad, mouse, touchpad, touchscreen, microphones, scanner, headset, or the like. The output device circuitry includes any physical or virtual means for showing information or otherwise conveying information, such as sensor readings, actuator position(s), or other like

information. Output device circuitry may include any number or combinations of audio or visual display, including, inter alia, one or more simple visual outputs/indicators (for example, binary status indicators such as light emitting diodes “LEDs” and multi-character visual outputs), or more complex outputs such as display devices or touchscreens (for example, liquid crystal displays “LCDs,” LED displays, quantum dot displays, projectors, etc.), with the output of characters, graphics, multimedia objects, and the like being generated or produced from the operation of the UE **800**.

(108) The driver circuitry **812** may include software and hardware elements that operate to control particular devices that are embedded in the UE **800**, attached to the UE **800**, or otherwise communicatively coupled with the UE **800**. The driver circuitry **812** may include individual drivers allowing other components to interact with or control various input/output (I/O) devices that may be present within, or connected to, the UE **800**. For example, driver circuitry **812** may include a display driver to control and allow access to a display device, a touchscreen driver to control and allow access to a touchscreen interface, sensor drivers to obtain sensor readings of sensor circuitry **728** and control and allow access to sensor circuitry **728**, drivers to obtain actuator positions of electro-mechanic components or control and allow access to the electro-mechanic components, a camera driver to control and allow access to an embedded image capture device, audio drivers to control and allow access to one or more audio devices.

(109) The PMIC **814** may manage power provided to various components of the UE **800**. In particular, with respect to the processors **802**, the PMIC **814** may control power-source selection, voltage scaling, battery charging, or DC-to-DC conversion.

(110) In some implementations, the PMIC **814** may control, or otherwise be part of, various power saving mechanisms of the UE **800** including DRX as discussed herein. A battery **818** may power the UE **800**, although in some examples the UE **800** may be mounted deployed in a fixed location, and may have a power supply coupled to an electrical grid. The battery **818** may be a lithium ion battery, a metal-air battery, such as a zinc-air battery, an aluminum-air battery, a lithium-air battery, and the like. In some implementations, such as in vehicle-based applications, the battery **818** may be a typical lead-acid automotive battery.

(111) Various components may be described as performing a task or tasks, for convenience in the description. Such descriptions should be interpreted as including the phrase “configured to.” Reciting a component that is configured to perform one or more tasks is expressly intended not to invoke 35 U.S.C. § 112(f) interpretation for that component.

(112) For one or more implementations, at least one of the components set forth in one or more of the preceding figures may be configured to perform one or more operations, techniques, processes, or methods as set forth in the example section below. For example, the baseband circuitry as described above in connection with one or more of the preceding figures may be configured to operate in accordance with one or more of the examples set forth below. For another example, circuitry associated with a UE, base station, network element, etc. as described above in connection with one or more of the preceding figures may be configured to operate in accordance with one or more of the examples set forth below in the example section.

EXAMPLES OF VARIOUS IMPLEMENTATIONS

(113) Example 1 includes a method comprising: identifying, by a relay device, a first message received from a first requesting device of a plurality of requesting devices; identifying, by the relay device, a second message received from a second requesting device of the plurality of requesting devices; determining, by the relay device based at least in part on a parameter of the first message, that the first message has a first priority level that satisfies a priority threshold; determining, by the relay device based at least in part on a parameter of the second message, that the second message has a second priority level that does not satisfy the priority threshold; transmitting a relay message to a remote device based at least in part on the first message; and transmitting a backoff message to the second requesting device.

(114) Example 2 includes the method of example 1, wherein the remote device is associated with an emergency service.

(115) Example 3 includes the method of any of examples 1-2, further comprising transmitting, by the relay device, a response message to the first requesting device.

(116) Example 4 includes the method of example 3, wherein the response message includes a request to establish a communication link between the relay device and the first requesting device.

(117) Example 5 includes the method of any of examples 3-4, wherein the response message includes a request for additional information.

(118) Example 6 includes the method of any of examples 3-5, wherein the response message includes an indication that the relay device sent a message to the remote device.

(119) Example 7 includes the method of any of examples 1-6, wherein the backoff message indicates a duration for the second requesting device to wait before transmitting another message to the relay device.

(120) Example 8 includes the method of any of examples 1-7, wherein the parameter of the first message is at least one of a message type of the first message, an identity of a user of the first requesting device, an indication of a proximity of the first requesting device to the relay device, or a signal quality parameter associated with the first requesting device.

(121) Example 9 includes the method of example 8, wherein the signal quality parameter is reference signal received power (RSRP).

(122) Example 10 includes the method of any of examples 1-9, wherein the first status message is one of a predefined set of status messages.

(123) Example 11 includes the method of any of examples 1-10, wherein the relay device comprises a user equipment (UE).

(124) Example 12 includes the method of any of examples 1-11, further comprising logically subdividing, by the relay device, a location at which the plurality of requesting devices are located, into a plurality of location segments.

(125) Example 13 includes the method of example 12, wherein the first requesting device and the second requesting device are in a first location segment of the plurality of location segments, and wherein the method further comprises: transmitting, by the relay device based at least in part on a determination that a third message received from a third requesting device in a second location segment of the plurality of location segments has a third priority level that satisfies the priority threshold, a second response message to the third requesting device; and transmitting, by the relay device based at least in part on the determination that a fourth message received from a fourth requesting device in the second location segment has a fourth priority level that does not satisfy the priority threshold, a second backoff message to the fourth requesting device.

(126) Example 14 includes the method of any of examples 1-13, wherein the first emergency situation is the same emergency situation as the second emergency situation.

(127) Example 15 includes a method comprising: generating, by a requesting device based at least in part on a user input, a status message related to an emergency situation at a location of the requesting device; transmitting, by the requesting device, the status message to a relay device; and identifying, by the requesting device based at least in part on the status message, a message received from the relay device; wherein: the message received from the relay device is a high priority emergency response message if the relay device determines that the status message has a high priority level; or the message received from the relay device is a backoff message if the relay device determines that the status message has a priority level that is different than a high priority level.

(128) Example 16 includes the method of example 15, wherein the priority level of the status message is based at least in part on at least one of a message type of the status message, an identity of a user of the requesting device, a proximity of the requesting device to the relay device, and a signal quality parameter of the requesting device.

(129) Example 17 includes the method of any of examples 15 or 16, wherein generating the status message comprises identifying, by the requesting device based at least in part on the user input, a preidentified status message of a plurality of preidentified status messages.

(130) Example 18 includes the method of any of examples 15-17, wherein the high priority emergency response message includes a request to establish an audio, visual, or both, communication link between the requesting device and the relay device.

(131) Example 19 includes the method of any of examples 15-18, wherein the message received from the relay device is the high priority emergency response message that includes a request for more information from the requesting device.

(132) Example 20 includes the method of any of examples 15-19, wherein the message received from the relay device comprises an indication that the relay device sent another message to an emergency services system.

(133) Example 21 includes the method of any of examples 15-20, further comprising determining, by the requesting device, whether the message received from the relay device is a backoff message; and based at least in part on determining that the message received from the relay device is a backoff message, initiating a timer with a duration that indicates a time for the requesting device to wait before transmitting the status message to the relay device again

(134) Example 22 includes the method of any of examples 15-21, wherein the backoff message includes an indication of a duration until the requesting device can transmit another status message to the relay device.

(135) Example 23 includes the method of any of examples 15-22, wherein the requesting device comprises a UE.

(136) Example 24 includes a method comprising: advertising that an apparatus has network connectivity to at least one destination; receiving two or more request messages, each of the two or more request messages received from a corresponding device of two or more requesting devices that does not include the at least one destination, wherein the two or more request messages comprises one or more first request messages and one or more second request messages; selecting, from the two or more request messages and using corresponding priorities, the one or more first request messages; forwarding, using the network connectivity and to a corresponding destination from the at least one destination, the one or more first request messages; and transmitting, to each device in a subset of devices from the two or more requesting devices, a backoff message, wherein each second request message from the one or more second request messages was received from a device in the subset of devices.

(137) Example 25 includes the method of example 24, comprising determining, based at least in part on a first network status of the apparatus and a second network status, to advertise that the apparatus current has network connectivity.

(138) Example 26 includes the method of example 25, comprising: determining, as the first network status of the apparatus, that the apparatus has a connection to a first type of network; and determining, as the second network status of the apparatus, that the apparatus does not have a connection to a second, different type of network.

(139) Example 27 includes the method of any of examples 24-26, wherein selecting the one or more first request messages comprises: selecting one message from the one or more first request messages at a first time within a threshold time period of receipt of the one message; and selecting another message from the one or more first request messages at a second time after the first time within the threshold time period of receipt of the other message, wherein the first time and the second time are different times.

(140) Example 28 includes the method of any of examples 24-27, receiving the two or more request messages comprises receiving the two or more request messages over a time period; selecting the one or more first request messages comprises: determining that the time period has elapsed after receipt of an earliest received message from the two or more request messages; and

selecting, from the two or more request messages and based at least in part on the determination that the time period has elapsed, the one or more first request messages.

(141) Example 29 includes the method of any of examples 24-28, wherein transmitting the backoff message comprises broadcasting, to the devices in the subset of devices, the backoff message.

(142) Example 30 includes the method of any of examples 24-29, wherein selecting the one or more first request messages comprises: determining, for at least some requesting devices of the two or more requesting devices, a corresponding priority; and selecting, based at least in part on the corresponding priorities of the requesting device from which the request message was received, the one or more first request messages.

(143) Example 31 includes the method of any of examples 24-30, comprising after forwarding the one or more first request messages, transmitting, to at least one requesting device from which the apparatus received a corresponding first request message from the one or more first request messages, an acknowledgement message instructing the corresponding requesting device to back off for a first time period, wherein the backoff message instructs the corresponding device in the subset of devices to back off for a second time period that is shorter than the first time period.

(144) Example 32 includes a method comprising identifying an event disrupting connectivity to a first network; determining, for an apparatus, that the apparatus has a connection to a second network; transmitting a message indicating to one or more neighboring devices that the apparatus has network connectivity; receiving a first relay request from a first device and a second relay request from a second device; forwarding, using the connection to the second network, a message associated with the first relay request; and transmitting, to the second device, a backoff message.

(145) Example 33 includes the method of example 32, comprising: determining, based at least in part on identifying the event disrupting connectivity to the first network and determining that the apparatus has a connection to the second network, to transmit the message indicating that the apparatus has network connectivity, wherein transmitting the message is based at least in part on determining to transmit the message.

(146) Example 34 includes the method of example 33, wherein: the first network comprises a first type of network; and the second network comprises a second, different type of network.

(147) Example 35 includes the method of any of examples 32-34, wherein identifying the event disrupting connectivity to the first network comprises determining that the apparatus lost a connection with the first network.

(148) Example 36 includes the method of any of examples 32-35, wherein identifying the event disrupting connectivity to the first network comprises receiving, from a third party system, data that indicates the disruption to connectivity to the first network.

(149) Example 37 includes the method of any of examples 32-36, wherein: receiving the first relay request and the second relay request comprises: receiving, from the first device, the first relay request at a first time; and receiving, from the second device, the second relay request at a second time that is after the first time; forwarding the message associated with the first relay request is responsive to determining that the first time satisfies a time threshold; and transmitting, to the second device, the backoff message is responsive to determining that the second time does not satisfy the time threshold.

(150) Example 38 includes the method of any of examples 32-37, wherein transmitting the backoff message comprises broadcasting, to a plurality of second devices that includes the second device, the backoff message.

(151) Example 39 includes the method of any of examples 32-38, wherein: forwarding the message associated with the first relay request is responsive to determining that a first priority for the first relay request satisfies a priority threshold; and transmitting, to the second device, the backoff message is responsive to determining that a second priority for the second relay request does not satisfy the priority threshold.

(152) Example 40 includes the method of any of examples 32-39, comprising, after forwarding the

message, transmitting, to the first device, an acknowledgement message instructing the first device to back off for a first time period, wherein the backoff message instructs the second device to back off for a second time period that is shorter than the first time period.

(153) Example 41 includes an apparatus comprising means to perform the method of any of examples 1-40.

(154) Example 42 includes one or more non-transitory computer-readable media comprising instructions that, upon execution of the instructions by one or more processors of an electronic device, are to cause the electronic device to perform the method of any of examples 1-40.

(155) Example 43 includes an electronic device comprising: one or more processors; and one or more non-transitory computer-readable media comprising instructions that, upon execution of the instructions by one or more processors of an electronic device, are to cause the electronic device to perform the method of any of examples 1-40.

(156) Example 44 includes an apparatus configured to perform one or more of the disclosed operations.

(157) Example 45 includes a system as described herein for performing one or more of the disclosed operations.

(158) A system, e.g., a base station, an apparatus including one or more baseband processors, and so forth, can be configured to perform particular operations or actions by virtue of having software, firmware, hardware, or a combination of them installed on the system that in operation causes or cause the system to perform the actions. The operations or actions performed either by the system can include the methods of any one of examples 1-40 or the other examples described throughout this specification.

(159) Any of the above-described examples may be combined with any other example (or combination of examples), unless explicitly stated otherwise. The foregoing description of one or more implementations provides illustration and description, but is not intended to be exhaustive or to limit the scope of implementations to the precise form disclosed. Modifications and variations are possible in light of the above teachings or may be acquired from practice of various implementations.

(160) Although the implementations above have been described in considerable detail, numerous variations and modifications will become apparent to those skilled in the art once the above disclosure is fully appreciated. It is intended that the following claims be interpreted to embrace all such variations and modifications.

(161) It is well understood that the use of personally identifiable information should follow privacy policies and practices that are generally recognized as meeting or exceeding industry or governmental requirements for maintaining the privacy of users. In particular, personally identifiable information data should be managed and handled so as to minimize risks of unintentional or unauthorized access or use, and the nature of authorized use should be clearly indicated to users.

Claims

1. A method comprising: identifying an event disrupting connectivity of an apparatus to a first network; determining, for the apparatus, that the apparatus has a connection to a second network; based at least in part on identifying the event disrupting connectivity of the apparatus to the first network and determining that the apparatus has the connection to the second network, determining to transmit a message for the apparatus indicating that the apparatus has network connectivity, based at least in part on determining to transmit the message for the apparatus, transmitting the message indicating to one or more neighboring devices that the apparatus has network connectivity; receiving a first relay request that was transmitted from a first device to the apparatus and a second relay request that was transmitted from a second device to the apparatus; forwarding,

using the connection of the apparatus to the second network, a message associated with the first relay request; and transmitting, to the second device, a backoff message.

2. The method of claim 1, wherein: the first network comprises a first type of network; and the second network comprises a second, different type of network.

3. The method of claim 1, wherein identifying the event disrupting connectivity of the apparatus to the first network comprises determining that the apparatus lost a connection with the first network.

4. The method of claim 1, wherein identifying the event disrupting connectivity of the apparatus to the first network comprises receiving, from a third party system, data that indicates the disruption to connectivity of the apparatus to the first network.

5. The method of claim 1, wherein: receiving the first relay request and the second relay request comprises: receiving, from the first device, the first relay request at a first time; and receiving, from the second device, the second relay request at a second time that is after the first time; forwarding the message associated with the first relay request is responsive to determining that the first time satisfies a time threshold; and transmitting, to the second device, the backoff message is responsive to determining that the second time does not satisfy the time threshold.

6. The method of claim 1, wherein transmitting the backoff message comprises broadcasting, to a plurality of second devices that includes the second device, the backoff message.

7. The method of claim 1, wherein: forwarding the message associated with the first relay request is responsive to determining that a first priority for the first relay request satisfies a priority threshold; and transmitting, to the second device, the backoff message is responsive to determining that a second priority for the second relay request does not satisfy the priority threshold.

8. The method of claim 1, comprising, after forwarding the message, transmitting, to the first device, an acknowledgement message instructing the first device to back off for a first time period, wherein the backoff message instructs the second device to back off for a second time period that is shorter than the first time period.

9. An apparatus comprising processing circuitry and memory on which are stored instructions that are operable, when executed by the processing circuitry, to cause the processing circuitry to perform operations comprising: identifying an event disrupting connectivity of a second apparatus to a first network; determining, for the second apparatus, that the apparatus has a connection to a second network; based at least in part on identifying the event disrupting connectivity of the second apparatus to the first network and determining that the second apparatus has the connection to the second network, determining, for the second apparatus, to transmit the message indicating that the second apparatus has network connectivity; based at least in part on determining to transmit the message for the second apparatus, transmitting the message indicating to one or more neighboring devices that the second apparatus has network connectivity; receiving a first relay request that was transmitted from a first device to the second apparatus and a second relay request that was transmitted from a second device to the second apparatus; forwarding, using the connection of the second apparatus to the second network, a message associated with the first relay request; and transmitting, to the second device, a backoff message.

10. The apparatus of claim 9, wherein: the first network comprises a first type of network; and the second network comprises a second, different type of network.

11. The apparatus of claim 9, wherein identifying the event disrupting connectivity of the second apparatus to the first network comprises determining that the second apparatus lost a connection with the first network.

12. The apparatus of claim 9, wherein identifying the event disrupting connectivity of the second apparatus to the first network comprises receiving, from a third party system, data that indicates the disruption to connectivity of the second apparatus to the first network.

13. The apparatus of claim 9, wherein: receiving the first relay request and the second relay request comprises: receiving, from the first device, the first relay request at a first time; and receiving, from the second device, the second relay request at a second time that is after the first time; forwarding

- the message associated with the first relay request is responsive to determining that the first time satisfies a time threshold; and transmitting, to the second device, the backoff message is responsive to determining that the second time does not satisfy the time threshold.
14. The apparatus of claim 9, wherein transmitting the backoff message comprises broadcasting, to a plurality of second devices that includes the second device, the backoff message.
15. The apparatus of claim 9, wherein: forwarding the message associated with the first relay request is responsive to determining that a first priority for the first relay request satisfies a priority threshold; and transmitting, to the second device, the backoff message is responsive to determining that a second priority for the second relay request does not satisfy the priority threshold.
16. The apparatus of claim 9, the operations comprising, after forwarding the message, transmitting, to the first device, an acknowledgement message instructing the first device to back off for a first time period, wherein the backoff message instructs the second device to back off for a second time period that is shorter than the first time period.
17. One or more non-transitory computer storage media encoded with instructions that, when executed by processing circuitry, cause the processing circuitry to perform operations comprising: identifying an event disrupting connectivity of an apparatus to a first network; determining, for the apparatus, that the apparatus has a connection to a second network; based at least in part on identifying the event disrupting connectivity of the apparatus to the first network and determining that the apparatus has the connection to the second network, determining to transmit a message for the apparatus indicating that the apparatus has network connectivity; based at least in part on determining to transmit the message for the apparatus, transmitting the message indicating to one or more neighboring devices that the apparatus has network connectivity; receiving a first relay request that was transmitted from a first device to the apparatus and a second relay request that was transmitted from a second device to the apparatus; forwarding, using the connection of the apparatus to the second network, a message associated with the first relay request; and transmitting, to the second device, a backoff message.
18. The media of claim 17, wherein identifying the event disrupting connectivity of the apparatus to the first network comprises determining that the apparatus lost a connection with the first network.
19. The media of claim 17, wherein identifying the event disrupting connectivity of the apparatus to the first network comprises receiving, from a third party system, data that indicates the disruption to connectivity of the apparatus to the first network.
20. The apparatus of claim 9, wherein the apparatus and the second apparatus are the same device.
-